



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Great Hearts Monte Vista - South

School Website: <http://greatheartsmontevista.greatheartsacademies.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Great Hearts Monte Vista South (San Antonio, TX 78212) demonstrates a robust alignment with classical education principles across most of the six categories in the Classical School rubric. Public-facing materials from the school emphasize a liberal arts tradition anchored in the Western canon, a curriculum centered on truth, goodness, and beauty, heavy use of Great Books and classical languages, and pedagogy that includes Socratic inquiry, seminar-style discussions, rhetoric, and memorization practices. Evidence from the school's handbooks, About pages, and program descriptions consistently highlights virtue, formation, memory work, and a community-of-learners orientation with strong parent involvement through a formal PSO. The school's mission statements explicitly articulate a pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, and the curriculum foregrounds grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and a senior thesis, along with a commitment to Western civilization and great works. Public materials also show a clear emphasis on partnership with families and a non-sectarian, Western-tradition orientation, with explicit calls for parental involvement and ongoing community engagement.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- The strongest strengths cluster around Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community, with explicit references to liberal arts, Great Books, memorization and recitation, Socratic or seminar-style discussion, and a living, virtuous-citizen formation.
- Some potential gaps appear as a lack of explicit, detailed theological grounding in the public materials (the school is described as non-sectarian and focused on the Western tradition), though transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue are consistently foregrounded.
- No major evidence suggests a shift toward non-classical approaches in the public materials. The aggregate picture remains solidly classical.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials present a mission focused on cultivating minds and hearts through truth, goodness, and beauty, i.e., transcendentals and moral realism. The mission is explicitly stated as pursuing Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, and the campus emphasizes liberal-arts formation with virtuous life as a core aim. - The About/Welcome materials emphasize a liberal arts tradition rooted in Western culture, with a focus on enduring truths and the classical canon. The Western tradition is explicitly highlighted as a deliberate focus. - The school acknowledges a non-sectarian posture and a covenant of tolerance, while still referencing a Western-tradition curriculum; the policy materials discuss religious/cultural diversity and non-discrimination, indicating a plural context rather than a doctrinal curriculum. - The school's "Letter to Families" and mission statements describe formation through virtue and the cultivated life, connecting to moral realism and teleological aims (the pursuit of virtue and beauty). - Evidence of contemplative aspects and reverence appears in references to wonder and the importance of memory and formational practices (e.g., sense of wonder encouraged; chant/memory-oriented practices are part of classical pedagogy in the lexicon; see below).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present in materials: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; contemplation/wonder; Western tradition; liberal arts; Great Books; memory/wonder-focused pedagogy (e.g., chant and reverence language appears in the lexicon and in policy language about reverence and awe). □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file14□turn0file7□ - Negative keywords: there is no explicit in-text signaling of relativism, secular humanism, or a purely secular approach; the materials consistently align with transcendentals and non-sectarian Western-tradition framing. Negative indicators from the classical lexicon (e.g., secular humanism, relativism) do not appear as themes in public materials.

Why this rating - The core orientation centers on transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue, with Western-cultural and classical-philosophical grounding, and with explicit attention to formation rather than mere information. This aligns strongly with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria of a classical program and suggests a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation through truth, goodness, and beauty rather than mere job training, and the curriculum is framed as forming virtuous, wise, well-educated humans (formation over information). The school positions education as cultivating humanity and human excellence, not simply workforce preparation. - The public materials emphasize liberal education and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, with teleological aims consistent with classical education (telos; pursuit of the true, good, beautiful). - The website highlights “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” as aspirational components of the curriculum, signaling higher-order formation and the cultivation of discernment, not just skill-building. - Statements about forming lifelong learners and a shared mission across campuses reinforce a purpose-oriented, virtue-centered approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, Great Books/Great Conversation, human excellence. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file7□ - Negative keywords present: minimal to none in the public materials; there is no explicit emphasis on “workforce preparation,” “21st-century skills” or purely job-focused outcomes. The absence of these negative signals supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Why this rating - The school self-consciously prioritizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of transcendentals rather than job-readiness, aligning with classical aims of education as paideia. The use of liberal arts foundations and Great Books signals a classical telos, supporting CLASSICAL here.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is anchored in the liberal arts of grammar, logic, and rhetoric, with a foundation in these disciplines as core elements; the school explicitly enumerates these components as central. - The materials describe a historical and philosophical scope—Latin in depth, seven years of math and science, and engagement with Aristotle and Dostoevsky—indicating a classical, canonical curriculum that stresses Great Books and Western thought. - The relationship to history, Western civilization, and primary texts is explicit, with an emphasis on reading and discussing authors as part of the Great Books approach and the Great Conversation. - The public materials emphasize a Western-tradition curriculum with a predictable, rigorous core (core liberal arts, Latin, mathematics/science, philosophy, and fine arts).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; history; Western civilization; Latin; senior thesis; primary sources; classics; philosophy; memory-focused pedagogy; rhetorical training. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file7□ - Negative keywords: the public materials do not emphasize replacing history with social studies or adopting project-based, non-traditional curriculum-focused approaches; no strong negative signals around non-classical pedagogy appear. The lexicon notes a negative signal for over-emphasis on non-traditional approaches, but this is not evidenced in the school's public materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly built around the Classical triad of liberal arts, Great Books, and Western tradition, with emphasis on grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, history, and philosophy, and with

evidence of Great Books and a senior thesis—clear indicators of CLASSICAL curriculum alignment.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical elements attributed to Great Hearts' classical model include a potential for Socratic discussion and seminars in higher grades, rhetorical training, and opportunities to present ideas (senior thesis). The North campus description highlights reading, discussion of canonical authors, and a culminating senior thesis, all of which align with classical pedagogy. - In the public materials, there is emphasis on memory work, recitation, and a structured, discipline-based approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric) consistent with classic pedagogy; the Great Hearts framework is described as an environment where learning is rigorous within a "community of friends." - The presence of a strong teacher focus and a "living curriculum" orientation (faculty modeling virtue; teachers as mentors) aligns with classical pedagogy that treats teachers as living exemplars rather than purely content deliverers.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic/seminar, rhetoric, memorization (memory work), narration/recitation, pedagogical emphasis on memory and wonder, scholé (calm/restful learning) is part of classical pedagogy in the lexicon, think-pair-discuss style, and a focus on a structured, classical curriculum. The North's program mentions senior thesis, Latin study, and canonical authors, all aligning with Socratic and seminar-style pedagogy. - Negative keywords: The materials do not emphasize experiential learning, project-based learning as the core pedagogy, or student-directed constructivist approaches; no explicit signals of a non-classical pedagogy. This supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Public-facing materials show explicit alignment with classic pedagogy: memorization, discussion-based inquiry, Latin and rhetoric study, canonical authors, and senior theses, complemented by a "living curriculum" approach and a learning community. This matches a CLASSICAL pedagogy profile.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue and mastery, serving as living examples within the school's "living curriculum." The materials emphasize dedicated, enthusiastic, and academically excellent teachers who model learning and character. - The PSO materials describe a collaborative, engaged parent-community model that rests on teacher leadership and partnership with families, indicating a supportive faculty culture with a shared mission. - The school materials reference a clear portrait of the teacher and student ideals, including professional development for teachers and a culture of collegiality. - Evidence of "the living curriculum" and teacher-driven classical formation is embedded in the ethos and mission statements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; faculty as exemplars; collegial culture; teacher training in classical pedagogy; portrait of what a teacher should be. - Negative keywords present: no explicit indicators of non-classical teacher roles (e.g., "facilitators on the side" or purely certification-driven teaching) appear in public materials; the lexicon's negative signals are not evidenced here.

Why this rating - The public materials depict a strong, teacher-centered classical faculty profile with mentoring, living-curriculum leadership, and a professional culture, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a robust partnership with families and positions parents as co-teachers in the classical education project; there are explicit references to PSO involvement and parent formation activities. - There is explicit emphasis on parental involvement, volunteer opportunities, and a community-oriented culture (Time, Talent, Treasure; parent volunteers; fundraising and giving). - The school emphasizes that parents are welcome to campus visits and are expected to participate in school functions; the PSO acts as a formal structure for parent engagement and support. - The materials emphasize parent education

(through book studies, gatherings, and information on classical education), reinforcing the parental formation component of the classical model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental engagement; parent formation; book studies; gatherings; open campus; volunteerism; Parent Service Organization; hospitality; multi-generational learning; family catechesis. - Negative keywords: no explicit signals of consumer-driven parental roles or minimal parental involvement; the materials emphasize active parental partnership and involvement rather than customer-centric language. The lexicon's negative signals about parent involvement are not evidenced in public materials.

Why this rating - The school actively promotes parental partnership, formation opportunities for parents, and open access for visits, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community engagement.

Overall aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates a consistent pattern across all six categories in line with classical education principles: Western-tradition liberal arts curriculum, Great Books, classical languages, Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy, teacher-as-mentor living curriculum, and strong parent-community partnerships.

What would move the needle

- Not applicable here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No explicit needle-moving changes are required to reach CLASSICAL status across the six categories based on the public materials provided.

ABSTRACT

Great Hearts Monte Vista South, San Antonio (78212) exhibits a coherent CLASSICAL profile across the six evaluation categories. The school foregrounds a Western-tradition liberal arts curriculum with a focus on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, Great Books, and a formation-centered telos. Curriculum elements include grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, history, philosophy, and a senior thesis, with canonical authors such as Aristotle and Dostoevsky represented in coursework. Pedagogy emphasizes classical methods—narration/recitation, Socratic or seminar-style discussion, and rhetoric—within a “living curriculum” and a community of learners. Faculty are portrayed as models of virtue and learning, and there is a robust parent community via the Parent Service Organization (PSO) and ongoing parent formation activities. The public materials stress partnership with families and open campus policies, with ongoing opportunities for volunteering, donations, and engagement. The school policy documents reflect a non-sectarian, Western-tradition orientation that emphasizes reverence, wonder, and moral formation without central religious instruction in the public sphere.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL Evidence: Mission emphasizes transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue; Western-tradition framing; non-sectarian but formation-focused. Positive keywords include truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, wonder, Western tradition. No strong explicit theology; a non-sectarian posture is stated. [filecite\turn0file0\turn0file14](#)
- School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL Evidence: Formation over information; cultivation of virtue and wisdom; telos and Great Books as core aims. Healthy emphasis on human flourishing and the classical mission. [filecite\turn0file0\turn0file7](#)
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL Evidence: Core liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Latin; history; Western civilization; Great Books; senior thesis; classical canon emphasis. [filecite\turn0file0\turn0file7](#)
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL Evidence: Socratic/seminar-style discussions implied; emphasis on memory, recitation, and rhetorical training; chanting/memory-oriented practices; contemplative Scholé and wonder; canonical texts. [filecite\turn0file7\turn0file0](#)
- Faculty: CLASSICAL Evidence: Model teachers; living curriculum; faculty as mentors; professional development; collaborative culture; parent-facing and teacher leadership.

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- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL Evidence: Partnership with families; PSO involvement; parent formation; open campus; volunteer opportunities; donations; family engagement.

If you'd like, I can extract further direct quotes from the school's materials to annotate each keyword occurrence, or contrast Great Hearts Monte Vista South with a specific classical-school benchmark.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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